U.S. Federal Government Fiscal Operations Bulletin

Analysis of On-Budget and Off-Budget Agency Outlays

Compiled from Treasury Bulletin Data

Covering Fiscal Years 2008 through 2017

Financial Management Service

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Abstract

This report compiles on-budget and off-budget outlay data for selected major agencies of the U.S. Federal Government for fiscal years 2008 through 2017. All figures are excerpted from Tables FFO-3 and FFO-4 published quarterly in the *Treasury Bulletin*. The report systematically presents appropriation execution profiles by agency over the ten-year span and explains the on-budget/off-budget classification framework under the unified budget concept, the treatment of offsetting collections, and issues bearing on Federal fiscal sustainability. Readers may apply appropriate statistical methods to the data presented herein to conduct independent calculations of the magnitude and central tendency of agency outlay changes.

Contents

1 Introduction and Compilation Notes

The Federal fiscal data cited in this report are drawn from the *Treasury Bulletin*, compiled quarterly by the Financial Management Service of the U.S. Department of the Treasury. That bulletin has been published regularly since 1945 and covers core fiscal information on Federal receipts and outlays, public debt, monetary circulation, and international financial statistics.

Budget authority is ordinarily provided through appropriations that authorize agencies to incur obligations and make payments. Reappropriations represent congressional action to extend the availability of unobligated balances and are counted as new budget authority in the fiscal year of the reappropriation act. Obligations are generally liquidated through check issuance or cash payment, which constitute outlays; outlays may also be recorded on a noncash basis through accrual of interest on the public debt or issuance of bonds or notes.

The difference between total Federal receipts and total Federal outlays constitutes the budget surplus or deficit. Since 1969, the Federal Government has employed the unified budget concept, incorporating all fiscal transactions between the Government and the public within a single budget framework. Since 1971, however, certain Federal entities have been placed off budget by law. Under current law, off-budget Federal entities comprise the social security trust funds (Old-Age and Survivors Insurance and Federal Disability Insurance trust funds) and the Postal Service. Although receipts, outlays, and surpluses or deficits of off-budget entities are generally not subject to targets set in congressional budget resolutions, the Balanced Budget and Emergency Deficit Control Act of 1985 (as amended) incorporates off-budget surpluses or deficits into calculations of deficit targets and excess deficits.

The sections that follow present in detail agency outlay data for fiscal years 2008–2017 as reported in Table FFO-3, together with supplementary aggregations for fiscal years 2012 and 2017 from Table FFO-4.

2 Summary Table of Federal Agency Budget Outlays (FFO-3)

The tables below are derived from the *Monthly Treasury Statement of Receipts and Outlays of the United States Government* and cover ten complete fiscal years from 2008 through 2017. Table FFO-3 presents combined on-budget and off-budget outlays by agency in millions of dollars. The figures shown are actual amounts and exclude estimates from the President's budget.

2.1 First Group of Agencies (Fiscal Years 2008–2012)

The following data are excerpted from Table FFO-3 on pages 16–17 of the **December 2012** *Treasury Bulletin*, which presents historical data for fiscal years 2008 through 2012.

Table 1: Federal Agency Budget Outlays (I): Fiscal Years 2008–2012

Agency	**2008**	**2009**	**2010**	**2011**	**2012**
Legislative Branch	4,409	4,703	5,838	4,583	4,438
Judicial Branch	6,345	6,643	7,185	7,295	7,228
Department of Agriculture	90,789	114,436	129,454	139,394	139,712
Department of Commerce	7,725	10,720	13,233	9,930	10,267
Department of Defense–Military	594,656	636,772	666,717	678,077	650,869
Department of Education	65,957	53,387	92,858	64,271	57,248
Department of Energy	21,404	23,684	30,775	31,371	32,485
Department of Health and Human Services	700,454	796,266	854,060	891,245	848,055
Department of Homeland Security	40,683	51,720	44,455	45,744	47,423
Department of Housing and Urban Development	49,086	61,018	60,143	57,008	49,591
Department of the Interior	9,822	11,778	13,163	13,529	12,886
Department of Justice	26,544	27,713	29,558	30,518	31,161
Department of Labor	58,840	138,156	173,053	131,973	104,742

Unit: millions of dollars. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2012, Table FFO-3.

Table 2: Federal Agency Budget Outlays (II): Fiscal Years 2008–2012 (continued)

Agency	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012
Department of State	17,493	21,430	23,804	24,334	26,948
Department of Transportation	64,945	73,006	77,751	77,302	75,148
Department of the Treasury–Interest on the Public Debt (gross)	451,154	383,073	413,955	454,015	359,240
Department of the Treasury–Other	97,658	318,701	30,385	82,720	105,456
Department of Veterans Affairs	84,746	95,454	108,275	126,917	124,127
Corps of Engineers	5,077	6,840	9,875	10,138	7,777
Other Defense–Civil Programs	45,783	57,276	54,031	54,775	77,316
Environmental Protection Agency	7,938	8,070	11,007	10,770	12,794
Executive Office of the President	1,172	742	583	484	405
General Services Administration	342	320	861	1,889	1,754
International Assistance Programs	11,362	14,801	20,040	20,601	20,060

Unit: millions of dollars. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2012, Table FFO-3 (continued).

Table 3: Federal Agency Budget Outlays (III): Fiscal Years 2008–2012 (continued)

Agency	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012
National Aeronautics and Space Administration	17,834	19,168	18,906	17,617	17,190
National Science Foundation	5,786	5,958	6,720	7,146	7,255
Office of Personnel Management	64,393	72,302	69,916	74,091	79,456
Small Business Administration	528	2,246	6,126	6,162	2,937
Social Security Administration	657,799	727,549	754,182	784,194	821,145
Independent agencies	45,192	50,356	−3,094	14,505	34,007
Employer share, employee retirement	−66,178	−70,656	−77,036	−79,681	−83,938
Interest received by trust funds	−191,537	−181,561	−185,764	−188,017	−127,142
Outer Continental Shelf rents and royalties	−18,285	−5,293	−4,883	−6,384	−6,606
Other	−1,790	−16,690	−197	−431	−12,993
Total outlays (on-budget)	2,503,371	3,003,070	2,901,248	3,099,477	3,030,856
Total outlays (off-budget)	474,751	517,018	554,684	498,609	507,589

Unit: millions of dollars. Negative values indicate offsetting receipts or credits. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2012, Table FFO-3 (continued). Column entries should not be summed directly because offsetting receipts have been deducted from related agency outlays.

2.2 Second Group of Agencies (Fiscal Years 2013–2017)

The following data are excerpted from Table FFO-3 on pages 16–17 of the **December 2017** *Treasury Bulletin*, which presents historical data for fiscal years 2013 through 2017.

Table 4: Federal Agency Budget Outlays (IV): Fiscal Years 2013–2017

Agency	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Legislative Branch	4,328	4,156	4,328	4,344	4,499
Judicial Branch	7,066	6,900	7,130	7,497	7,565
Department of Agriculture	155,897	141,806	139,112	138,161	127,563
Department of Commerce	9,137	6,675	8,955	9,162	10,303
Department of Defense–Military	607,801	578,013	562,506	565,365	568,905
Department of Education	40,910	59,609	90,031	76,981	111,703
Department of Energy	24,677	23,630	25,425	25,852	25,794
Department of Health and Human Services	886,293	936,030	1,027,420	1,102,966	1,116,763
Department of Homeland Security	57,220	43,259	42,563	45,194	50,502
Department of Housing and Urban Development	56,577	38,524	35,522	26,393	55,474
Department of the Interior	9,605	11,273	12,348	12,584	12,141
Department of Justice	29,740	28,617	26,910	29,523	30,979
Department of Labor	80,309	57,199	45,218	41,371	40,121

Unit: millions of dollars. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2017, Table FFO-3.

Table 5: Federal Agency Budget Outlays (V): Fiscal Years 2013–2017 (continued)

Agency	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017
Department of State	25,928	27,504	26,494	29,447	27,061
Department of Transportation	76,317	76,154	75,451	78,421	79,440
Department of the Treasury–Interest on the Public Debt (gross)	415,671	429,568	402,183	429,964	456,953
Department of the Treasury–Other	−16,618	17,361	83,447	96,153	89,479
Department of Veterans Affairs	138,463	149,074	159,220	174,019	176,046
Corps of Engineers	6,301	6,533	6,684	6,389	6,452
Other Defense–Civil Programs	56,811	57,372	62,966	64,505	58,695
Environmental Protection Agency	9,485	9,400	7,006	8,729	8,087
Executive Office of the President	380	373	392	395	412
General Services Administration	−368	−765	−889	−734	−667
International Assistance Programs	19,745	18,609	20,976	16,242	18,925

Unit: millions of dollars. Negative values indicate net receipts or credit balances. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2017, Table FFO-3 (continued).

Table 6: Federal Agency Budget Outlays (VI): Fiscal Years 2013–2017 (continued)

Agency	**2013**	**2014**	**2015**	**2016**	**2017**
National Aeronautics and Space Administration	16,978	17,093	18,272	18,828	18,698
National Science Foundation	7,418	7,054	6,836	6,904	7,213
Office of Personnel Management	83,868	87,919	91,736	91,318	95,462
Small Business Administration	473	194	−747	−444	439
Social Security Administration	867,395	905,807	944,144	976,783	1,000,812
Independent agencies	25,906	4,192	13,575	13,160	11,658
Employer share, employee retirement	−81,321	−79,349	−81,120	−84,030	−84,970
Interest received by trust funds	−156,676	−158,115	−141,791	−146,118	−147,057
Outer Continental Shelf rents and royalties	−8,874	−7,473	−4,555	−2,783	−3,106
Other	−2,588	–	−30,128	−8,436	−1,750
Total outlays (on-budget)	2,820,440	2,798,103	2,944,526	3,077,747	3,179,404
Total outlays (off-budget)	633,815	706,095	743,097	776,354	801,202

Unit: millions of dollars. Negative values indicate offsetting receipts. "–" indicates no transactions. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2017, Table FFO-3 (continued).

3 Summary Table of Federal Government Receipts and Outlays (FFO-4)

Table FFO-4 provides summary receipt and outlay data by fund category. The two tables below present execution data through September for fiscal years 2012 and 2017, respectively, covering the general fund, management/consolidated/revolving/special funds, and trust funds, with comparison to the corresponding prior-year period.

3.1 Fiscal Year 2012 Summary

Table 7: Summary of U.S. Government Receipts and Outlays by Source and Agency: Fiscal Year 2012 through September Compared with Prior-Year Period (excerpt)

Category	**General Fund**	**Management/Revolving/Special Funds**	**Tru**
Fiscal Year 2012 through September			
Department of Defense–Military	645,673	5,012	
Department of Education	56,913	336	
Department of Energy	34,051	−1,567	
Department of Health and Human Services	607,717	−236	
Department of Homeland Security	49,679	−2,754	
Department of Transportation	16,946	−221	
Department of the Treasury–Interest on the Public Debt	359,241	–	
Department of the Treasury–Other	104,943	693	
Department of Veterans Affairs	125,855	−2,762	
National Aeronautics and Space Administration	17,275	−86	
National Science Foundation	7,143	109	
Social Security Administration	188,232	9	
Independent agencies	10,929	18,307	
Undistributed offsetting receipts–Interest			
Undistributed offsetting receipts–Other			
Total outlays	2,689,839	37,450	
Of which: on-budget	2,689,583	35,036	
Of which: off-budget	256	2,415	
Fiscal Year 2011 through September (comparison)			
Department of Defense–Military	676,253	1,685	
National Aeronautics and Space Administration	17,612	4	

Unit: millions of dollars. "–" indicates no transactions. "*" indicates less than $500 thousand. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2012, Table FFO-4 (page 18).

3.2 Fiscal Year 2017 Summary

Table 8: Summary of U.S. Government Receipts and Outlays by Source and Agency: Fiscal Year 2017 through September Compared with Prior-Year Period (excerpt)

Category	**General Fund**	**Management/Revolving/Special Funds**	**Tru**
Fiscal Year 2017 through September			
Department of Defense–Military	568,766	−64	
Department of Education	112,627	−926	
Department of Energy	27,642	−1,846	
Department of Health and Human Services	844,243	7,755	
Department of Homeland Security	51,268	−967	
Department of Transportation	10,105	−14	
Department of the Treasury–Interest on the Public Debt	456,955	–	
Department of the Treasury–Other	89,305	151	
Department of Veterans Affairs	178,856	−3,604	
National Aeronautics and Space Administration	18,712	−16	
National Science Foundation	7,111	118	
Social Security Administration	93,326	1	
Independent agencies	10,479	−4,437	
Undistributed offsetting receipts–Interest			
Undistributed offsetting receipts–Other			
Total outlays	2,913,517	−9,831	1
Of which: on-budget	2,913,247	−7,288	
Of which: off-budget	270	−2,543	
Fiscal Year 2016 through September (comparison)			
Department of Defense–Military	565,225	−107	
National Aeronautics and Space Administration	18,837	−10	

Unit: millions of dollars. "–" indicates no transactions. "*" indicates less than $500 thousand. Source: Treasury Bulletin, December 2017, Table FFO-4 (page 18).

4 Analysis of Federal Fiscal Receipt and Outlay Structure

4.1 On-Budget and Off-Budget Classification

Since 1969, the Federal Government has employed the unified budget concept, incorporating all fiscal transactions between the Government and the public within a comprehensive framework. Since 1971, however, certain Federal entities have successively been placed outside the budget framework by law, newly established off budget, or moved back on budget.

Under current law, off-budget Federal entities comprise only the Federal Old-Age and Survivors Insurance Trust Fund, the Federal Disability Insurance Trust Fund, and the United States Postal Service.

Although receipts, outlays, and surpluses or deficits of off-budget entities are generally not subject to targets set in congressional budget resolutions, the Balanced Budget and Emergency Deficit Control Act of 1985 (the Gramm-Rudman-Hollings Act, as amended by the Budget Enforcement Act of 1990) incorporates off-budget surpluses or deficits into the calculation of applicable deficit targets. For this reason, analysis and reporting of Federal fiscal conditions by government agencies consistently address both on-budget and off-budget dimensions of receipts, outlays, and deficits.

4.2 Treatment of Offsetting Collections

Under Federal accounting, offsetting collections fall into two broad categories:

(1) **Collections credited to appropriations or fund accounts**: ordinarily available for obligation without further congressional action, including fees authorized by law for materials or services (user charges, also termed receipts), and business-type income of the three revolving fund types (public enterprise, intragovernmental, and trust funds).

(2) **Offsetting receipts in receipt accounts**: available for obligation only through appropriation, subdivided into proprietary receipts (from the public), intragovernmental transactions (payments from appropriation or fund accounts), and offsetting governmental receipts (including foreign cash contributions).

In addition, four types of receipts are classified as **undistributed offsetting receipts** and are deducted directly from budget totals rather than assigned to any specific agency or functional category: employer contributions to employee retirement funds by agencies (including off-budget entities), interest received by trust funds, Outer Continental Shelf land rents and royalties, and other interest receipts.

4.3 Long-Run Trends in Outlay Levels

For total Federal outlays, over the ten years from fiscal year 2008 to fiscal year 2017, on-budget total outlays grew from approximately $2.50 trillion to approximately $3.18 trillion, implying a compound annual growth rate of about 2.7%. Off-budget outlays increased from approximately $474.751 billion to approximately $801.202 billion, a more pronounced rise driven chiefly by expansion in the scale of social security trust fund receipts and outlays.

Agency outlay levels differ greatly in magnitude. In fiscal year 2017, for example, total outlays of the Department of Health and Human Services exceeded $1.1 trillion and outlays of the Social Security Administration approached $1.0 trillion, whereas outlays of the National

Science Foundation were approximately $7.2 billion and outlays of the Executive Office of the President were less than $500 million. Outlays of the Legislative Branch, Judicial Branch, and similar agencies remained in the range of several billion dollars annually and were relatively stable.

Outlay fluctuations for individual agencies over the decade reflect multiple factors, including automatic stabilizer effects over the business cycle, appropriation changes under major legislation, and the initiation or termination of one-time programs. Detailed cross-agency comparisons may be found in the six FFO-3 summary tables in Section 2.

5 Appendix: Notes on Data Use

Data Sources and Limitations

All data cited in this report are taken from Tables FFO-3 (on-budget and off-budget outlays by agency) and FFO-4 (summary of government receipts and outlays by source and agency) as published in the *Treasury Bulletin* of the U.S. Department of the Treasury, specifically:

- *Treasury Bulletin*, December 2012, pages 16–18, covering fiscal years 2008–2012.
- *Treasury Bulletin*, December 2017, pages 16–18, covering fiscal years 2013–2017.

Both bulletins were compiled and publicly released by the Financial Management Service (subsequently renamed the Bureau of the Fiscal Service). Amounts in all tables are in millions of dollars unless otherwise noted.

The following points should be noted:

1. Cells marked "–" indicate no transactions in the period.
2. Cells marked "*" indicate amounts of less than $500 thousand.
3. Because of rounding, sums of detail lines may differ slightly from stated totals.
4. Certain agencies (such as Department of the Treasury–Other and the Small Business Administration) report net receipts (i.e., negative outlays) in individual fiscal years, chiefly owing to large offsetting collections or credit adjustments in those years.
5. Outlay data by agency represent the combined on-budget and off-budget outlays of the agency, stated in current dollars for each year without inflation adjustment.

Guidance on Statistical Methods

Readers employing the data in this report for statistical analysis may apply appropriate descriptive methods as needed, such as calculating the magnitude of outlay change, dispersion, or central tendency for a given agency over a specified period. For treatment of outliers, relevant robust statistical methods may be applied before analysis. All necessary original data are presented in full in the six tables in Section 2, on which readers may base independent quantitative calculations.